



Incident report analysis

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this chart as a way to practice applying the NIST framework to different situations you encounter.

Summary	A DoS attack occurred when an external actor flooded the company's network with ICMP packets. The firewall was misconfigured, allowing the traffic to pass unchecked. The attack caused a two-hour outage of internal services. The IT team blocked incoming ICMP traffic, restored critical systems, and began reviewing firewall rules.
Identify	The incident was a Denial-of-Service (DoS) attack using ICMP packets. Affected systems included the internal network, firewall, and DNS services. The root cause was a misconfigured firewall that failed to block ICMP traffic.
Protect	To prevent recurrence, the team should: • Properly configure the firewall to block unnecessary ICMP traffic. • Apply patch updates and maintain a secure baseline configuration. • Implement multi-factor authentication for administrative access. • Document and review firewall rules regularly.
Detect	Detection methods include: • Using SIEM tools to monitor network logs for abnormal ICMP patterns. • Setting alerts for traffic spikes or repeated requests from the same IP.

	• Reviewing IDS/IPS logs to identify suspicious activity early.
Respond	Response actions taken: • Blocked incoming ICMP packets at the firewall. • Isolated affected systems and restored critical services. • Captured and analyzed logs to confirm the attack source. • Documented the event and notified the incident response team.
Recover	Recovery steps: • Restored all network services to normal operation. • Verified firewall configuration and updated baseline documentation. • Conducted a post-incident review to improve response procedures. • Scheduled regular audits and staff training on firewall management.

Reflections/Notes:

Through this activity, I learned how the NIST Cybersecurity Framework organizes incident response into five clear functions: Identify, Protect, Detect, Respond, and Recover. Applying these steps helped me see how each phase connects — identifying the root cause (firewall misconfiguration), protecting systems through configuration and updates, detecting abnormal traffic with monitoring tools, responding quickly to contain the attack, and recovering by restoring services and improving documentation.

I also realized the importance of maintaining a baseline configuration and continuous monitoring. Even a small oversight, like leaving ICMP traffic unrestricted, can lead to major downtime. This

exercise reinforced how proactive hardening and regular audits are essential for preventing future incidents.